illegally detained, he refused to confess to a crime he hadn't committed. Of course you wouldn't know this if you read newspapers in the days following his arrest. They carried detailed descriptions of an entirely imaginary, non-existent confession. The Delhi Police portrayed Geelani as the evil mastermind of the Indian end of the conspiracy. Its scriptwriters orchestrated a hateful propaganda campaign against him, which was eagerly amplified and embellished by a hyper- nationalistic, thrill-seeking media. The police knew perfectly well that in criminal trials, judges are not supposed to take cognizance of media reports. So they knew that their entirely cold-blooded fabrication of a profile for these 'terrorists' would mould public opinion, and create a climate for the trial. But it would not come in for any legal scrutiny.

Here are some of the malicious, outright lies that appeared in the mainstream press:

'Case cracked: Jaish behind attack'[3]
(*Hindustan Times*)
'In Delhi, the Special Cell Detectives detained a Lecturer in Arabic, who teaches at Zakir Hussain College (Evening) . . . after it was established that he had received a call made by militants on his mobile phone.' Another column in the same paper said: 'Terrorists spoke to him before the attack and the lecturer made a phone call to Pakistan after the strike.'

'DU lecturer was terror plan hub'[4]
(*Times of India*)
'The attack on Parliament on December 13th was a joint operation of the Jaish-e-Mohammad (JeM) and Lashkar-e-Toiba (LeT) terrorist groups in which a Delhi University lecturer, Syed A.R. Gilani, was one of the key facilitators in Delhi, Police Commissioner Ajai Raj Sharma said on Sunday.'

'Varsity don guided "fidayeen"'[5]
(*Hindu*)
'During interrogation Geelani disclosed that he was in the know of the conspiracy since the day the "Fidayeen" attack was planned.'

'Don lectured on terror in free time'[6]
(*Hindustan Times*)
'Investigations have revealed that by evening he was at the college teaching Arabic literature. In his free time, behind closed doors, either at his house or